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readers is that they want an antivirus that just runs in the background, doesn't bother them too much, and shouldn't be resource hungry. What are you doing about this?

Gavin: Buy Norton Security! (laughs) Without a doubt! I mean, I can honestly say – despite the PR people's misgivings – that in 2004-2005, our product was sub optimal. We had some issues in 2006, with the heaviness of our product. We did a lot of work in 2007, and beyond in terms of getting out technology quick, getting it smaller, and getting it quicker to update, and these are the technologies we've revamped. Anytime I give somebody a copy of the latest version of the product, the installation time, the memory it hogs, how quiet it is on the PC, exceeds expectations. Have a look yourself.

1 From your perspective, what are your thoughts on the recent news of two hackers successfully managing to remotely hack a Jeep Cherokee? Does Norton have a play in the IoT space?

Gavin: What's happening, as you just said, is more and more devices are connecting to the internet. It used to be a PC, it's been your phone for the past couple of years but now you look at advanced households where IoT is more prevalent in certain markets, you would see the fridge is connected, the TV is connected, the kettle is connected, the alarm system's connected, your front door key is connected, your thermostat is connected. Sometimes it's using protocols that are not found in PCs and mobiles today. It's new types of protocols that have these kind of connectivity.

1 Yes many of them are embedded systems, so they are non x86.

Gavin: Exactly! Protecting these devices and protecting these communication channels is a huge issue. There are of course dumb devices that are not going to have any effect whether they get hacked or not like a bulb. But then you have other pieces... such as your alarm system, your car – that's a big issue. How organisations or individuals protect all of those devices is becoming super important. So there is some work that we have been doing over the last eight to 12 months, I think that the market is right for solutions to come in.

You look at the enterprise – it's pretty secure: there is policy, there is process, you have IT systems in place, you have CIOs and the ability to respond is good. The consumers with a personal devices, I think their awareness is low today. If you look at a home, the amount of devices that can potentially be internet connected, is massive. I think that's the next space where there is a huge market opportunity.

1 On your R&D side, do you work with government agencies, to protect critical infrastructure, like dam pressure valves or the electricity grids... those kind of things?

Gavin: To answer your question directly, yes, we have solutions that cover across all of enterprise whether it be government, whether it be large enterprise, banking or finance. The Norton side of the business is very much focused on consumers and the low end of small and medium enterprise. My type of business is around that. There is a lot of technologies that we have today and with the split, we will start to become lot more focus in the development of roadmap around those technologies that we have today. It's not just hackers as much, there is state sponsored, there is underground criminal groups – this is how they make their money.

1 Funny that you mentioned state sponsored, because I had a question about state sponsored cyber terrorism. What are your thoughts on that?

Gavin: It's a concern, across governments, all of the security industry in general. The ISTR – The Symantec Internet Security Threat Report that comes out has some information on that.

1 What is the biggest threat to a consumer's information security right now?

Gavin: The value of information that is swinging around in your purse or back pocket, That's becoming a concern. One of the first things I'd say in answering your question is educate yourself. Whether it's technology, whether is a process, or whether it's communication – having a conversation with your family, your kids, your mother and father – it's important to start understanding the threats that are out there.

1 For a long time, people use to think that Macintosh systems were unhackable, but in reality it was just that there weren't enough people on it and not enough money.

Gavin: Correct. And it's funny that it's really not the OS, now it could be the ecosystem around it that could have your personal information – credit card details, social security number.

1 One of the talking points you had was research from the quantified self, what was that about?

Gavin: In that respect we go back to connected devices. Any of those fitness devices that you wear on your person are IoT devices. I think it'll become more important as it becomes more common in people's lives.

1 How does it matter if a sensor monitoring your heart rate gets compromised?

Gavin: If it's your credit card details, your social security number, your date of birth, that's information you don't want anyone to know, but if information like you run 5 miles a day or, maybe your fitness levels, perhaps it's important to someone, maybe a health insurance company.

1 When we speak to our readers they all know of Norton and McAfee, but the free anti-virus brands are very popular here – AVG and Avast mainly.

Gavin: What happened over the course of the last three or four years, is that a lot of new players entered this market, thinking that this is an easy market. What you realize very quickly, is that if you don't have the scale, or you don't have the support system, when people are in trouble, they need to phone somebody. You can't do that with the free stuff. There is no way for these players to put in place those systems, there's no revenue to do that. Eventually, they all end up selling you something. When you want support from them, you can't get it. They enter business thinking they'll make a lot of money. But that didn't happen. Only one of them made any money. And even that player is being bought out by Private Equity. If you are not going to use anything, use something. But if you want best protection, use a paid option. **1**